

# Zero Sum RPG Scenario: The Time Thief

## Real-World Inspiration

This scenario is heavily anonymized but conceptually derived from current worldwide events regarding: **Stealing processing power from millions of neural implants**. It integrates modern digital demagogue mechanics and corporate overreach.

### 1. The Hook

The players are contracted to infiltrate a highly secure Server Cooling Tower. An influential **Tech Reviewer** has weaponized their parasocial swarm of millions of followers to act as an unwitting shield for an illegal operation happening inside. The authorities will not intervene out of fear of a massive PR disaster and riots.

### 2. The Digital Demagogue

The primary antagonist isn't a heavily armed warlord, but an influencer who commands attention. They don't use guns; they use live-streams. If the players are detected, the influencer will immediately broadcast their faces, instantly raising the Social Heat to maximum and doxxing them globally.

### 3. The Complication

Violence is not an option here. *Alternatively, the Faceless can attempt a DC 3 Subterfuge check to forge a localized bypass code, avoiding the confrontation entirely.* **The noise is deafening; communication is impossible.** If a single shot is fired, the Dead

Man's Zone rule applies, and the players will face an impossible extraction against overwhelming force.

## 4. Zero Sum Consistency Matrix (ZSCM)

To ensure the scenario maintains the brutal asymmetry of the *Zero Sum* system, the ZSCM values are pre-calculated:

- **Antagonist Power (E):** 8/10
- **Player Starting Resources (R):** 4/10
- **Initial Intel Asymmetry (I):** 4/10
- **Collateral Damage Risk (D):** 5/10
- **Total Stress Score:** 21/30 (Valid: Mechanically Solvable but Asymmetric)

## 5. Objectives & Extraction

1. **Infiltrate:** Bypass the physical security without alerting the follower swarm.
2. **Isolate:** Disconnect the influencer from the global network to stop the broadcast threat.
3. **Extract:** Secure the objective data and vanish before the algorithmic police response arrives.